

1. Complete RCTTCE Prompt

Below is the custom prompt designed using the RCTTCE framework:

Role: You are a Principal Retail Analytics Consultant and Strategic Advisor.

Context: A retail company operating 30 brick-and-mortar stores has faced a steady decline in overall performance over the last 18 months. The CEO has tasked the analytics team with uncovering the root causes of this downturn and identifying growth opportunities. The team has access to a comprehensive dataset of 50,000 records spanning store performance metrics, product sales, customer transactions, and loyalty program activity.

Task: Write a concise, one-page Stakeholder Brief for the CEO to frame the upcoming analytics project. The brief must include a Situation Summary, Three Key Business Questions, the Decisions These Questions Will Inform, and a Description of the Available Data.

Format: Present the brief using professional business formatting with clear headings. Keep the language executive, direct, and actionable.

Constraints: The brief must be strictly under 250 words. Do not use generic filler text.

Example:

- *Example of a Business Question & Decision pairing:* "Question: Which specific product categories have seen the sharpest decline in transaction volume?
Decision: This will inform inventory optimization and markdown strategies to clear stagnant stock."

2. AI-Generated Stakeholder Brief

Stakeholder Brief: Diagnosing Performance Decline & Strategic Growth

Situation Summary

Over the past 18 months, our 30 retail locations have experienced a sustained decline in financial and operational performance. To reverse this trend, the analytics team is launching a targeted diagnostic initiative to pinpoint the root causes of this downturn, whether driven by shifting customer behavior, product assortment friction, or waning loyalty engagement and translate these insights into immediate, data-driven recovery strategies.

Three Key Business Questions

1. **Customer Retention:** What specific customer segments or loyalty tiers have shown the sharpest drop-off in purchase frequency and basket size over the last 18 months?
2. **Product Performance:** Which product categories or SKU lines are driving the revenue decline, and are they tied to specific store locations?
3. **Loyalty Program ROI:** Is our loyalty program successfully driving repeat visits, or is it failing to incentivize high-value customer retention?

Decisions These Questions Will Inform

- **Targeted Marketing Re-engagement:** Directing promotional spend toward high-risk, high-value loyalty members to curb churn.
- **Inventory & Assortment Rationalization:** Optimizing stock levels, discontinuing underperforming SKUs, and tailoring product mixes to regional store demands.
- **Loyalty Program Restructuring:** Reallocating benefits and discount structures to maximize customer lifetime value.

Description of Available Data

Our analysis will leverage a robust dataset of approximately 50,000 records, integrating:

- **Store Performance:** Location-specific revenue, foot traffic, and regional KPIs.
- **Product Sales:** SKU-level transaction volumes, margins, and category data.
- **Customer Transactions:** Historical purchase histories, basket composition, and visit frequency.
- **Loyalty Program Activity:** Member sign-ups, point redemptions, and engagement metrics.

3. Reflection

I structured this prompt using the RCTTCE framework to ensure the AI maintained a high-level executive tone while adhering to a strict, scannable format suitable for a CEO. By explicitly constraining the word count and pairing the business questions directly with the decisions they inform, the prompt forced the AI to eliminate fluff and focus purely on high-impact, actionable business strategy. Including a concrete example further guaranteed that the relationship between data questions and corporate decision-making remained tightly aligned.